



Welcome to the AI-Hackathon!

Orientation

AI Working Group
March 11, 2026

Welcome!



Hackathon

Welcome!



Today's agenda

- Welcome
- Who's in the room
- AI Working Group Leadership Team
- Hackathon Rules
- Office Hours
- Get to know your team!

Who is in the room?



- Expected Attendance: 150-200 industry and government professionals
- 80 + hackathon participants
- 3-5 Government Judges
- 20 Teams

Our Leadership Team

AI Working Group Chairs



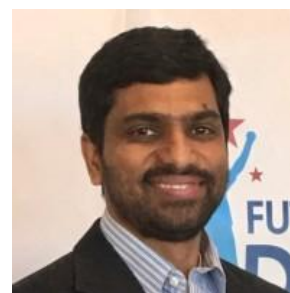
Paul Tibbits, M.D.
VA
Government Chair



Dr. Gabrielle Bedewi
Government Chair
Defense Threat
Reduction Agency
(DTRA)



Omar E. Bouaichi
Government Chair
HUD | Ginnie Mae Office
of Enterprise Data &
Technology Solutions



Gopa Nair
Government Chair
Department of Labor (DOL)
OASAM/OCIO



Ravi Gourineni
Industry Chair
Lithe Solutions
Co-Founder/CSO

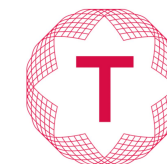


Bethlehem Belaineh
Industry Vice Chair
Theory AI
Founder & CEO



VA

U.S. Department
of Veterans Affairs



THEORY AI
YOUR PARTNER IN TECHNOLOGY

Hackathon Rules (part 1)

Eligibility & Team Formation

- Team size limits (e.g., 2–5 members per team)
- Participants must register by the deadline
- Each person can only be on one team
- Teams must have at least one designated team lead

Intellectual Property & Originality

- All work must be original and built during the Hackathon period
- No pre-built projects or significant prior work submitted as new
- Teams retain ownership of their work
- Any open-source tools/libraries must be disclosed

Code of Conduct

- Respectful communication among all participants
- No plagiarism or cheating
- No harassment or discrimination of any kind
- Violations result in disqualification

Hackathon Rules (part 2)

Submission Requirements

- Projects must be submitted by the deadline (no exceptions)
- Must include a demo, README, or presentation
- Code must be pushed to a shared repository (e.g., GitHub)
- Teams must present/demo their project to judges

Judging Criteria

- Innovation & creativity
- Technical complexity
- Practicality / real-world impact
- Quality of presentation/demo

Use of AI Tools

- Disclose any AI tools used (e.g., GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT)
- AI-generated code must be reviewed and understood by the team

General

- Judges' decisions are final
- Organizers reserve the right to disqualify teams for rule violations
- Participants must be available during judging windows

Hackathon Key Dates and TimeLines



Time Frame	Phase	Description	Milestone
Feb 2, 2026	Hackathon Announcement	Public announcement; registration opens; structure and rules published (use cases excluded)	Registration opens
Feb 2 – Feb 20, 2026	Use Case Development & Intake	Use cases developed by Steering Committee; industry use cases solicited and reviewed	Use cases finalized
Feb 20, 2026	Use Case Publication	Four (4) approved use cases published publicly with leads and sponsors identified	Use cases released
Feb 2 – Mar 6, 2026	Registration	Participants register and indicate use case and environment preferences	Registration closes
Mar 6 – Mar 11, 2026	Team Formation, Use Case & Environment Lock	Teams finalized based on registration option and interest, Use Case finalized and environment access checked	Teams confirmed
Mar 12 – Mar 25, 2026	Solutioning Sprint	14-day sprint to design and build MVP solutions	Working MVPs complete
Mar 25, 2026 (EOD, 5 PM)	Submission Lock	Final solutions and artifacts submitted	Submissions closed
Mar 27, 2026	Demo Day & Judging	Live demos, panels, judging, and awards	Winners announced

What's Next ?

Office Hours: Hosted Daily March 13-25



- **Confirm Your Teams**

- Confirm your Use-Cases
- Confirm your preferred environment
- Attend Office Hours
- Form a Project Plan
- Submit your Hackathon Project by 02/25/2026

Thank you! Q & A Time

Questions? Concerns?

Contact

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